

README.md

root | Markdown

BioSync — Human Operating System

Contactless cognitive load quantification via multimodal biosignal fusion.

Your CPU has a performance monitor. Your IDE has a profiler. Your body has nothing.

BioSync fixes that — using hardware you already own.

****"We don't ask how you feel. We measure it."****

What Is This, Exactly?

BioSync is **not** a wellness app. Not a chatbot. Not a mood tracker.

It is a **real-time cognitive load quantification system** that extracts biological stress signals from a standard webcam and microphone — no wearables, no manual input — and uses them to drive an OS-level adaptive response.

The technical core: a **weighted multimodal biosignal fusion engine** combining Remote Photoplethysmography (rPPG), vocal jitter analysis, and Hinglish intent classification into a single Cognitive Score, updated every 500ms. When that score crosses a threshold, the system doesn't notify you. It *responds* — changing UI state, generating a contextual AI intervention, and logging the outcome for future reference.

This is the difference between a dashboard and an operating system.

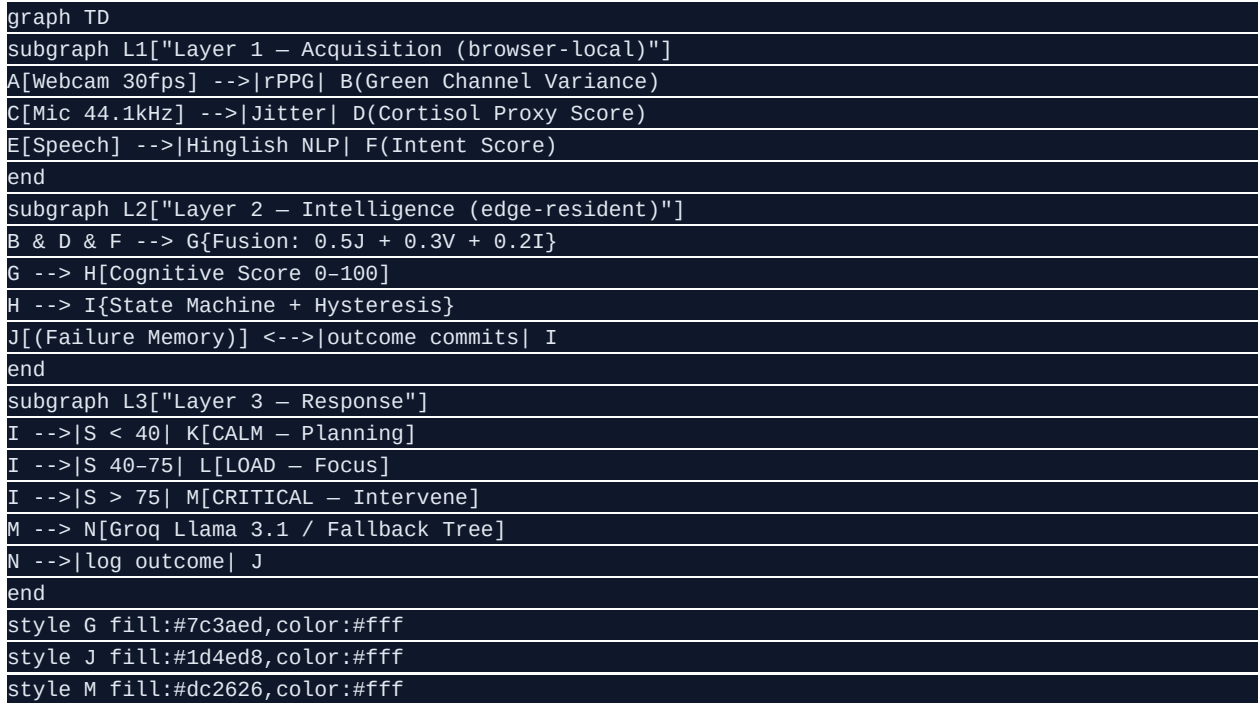
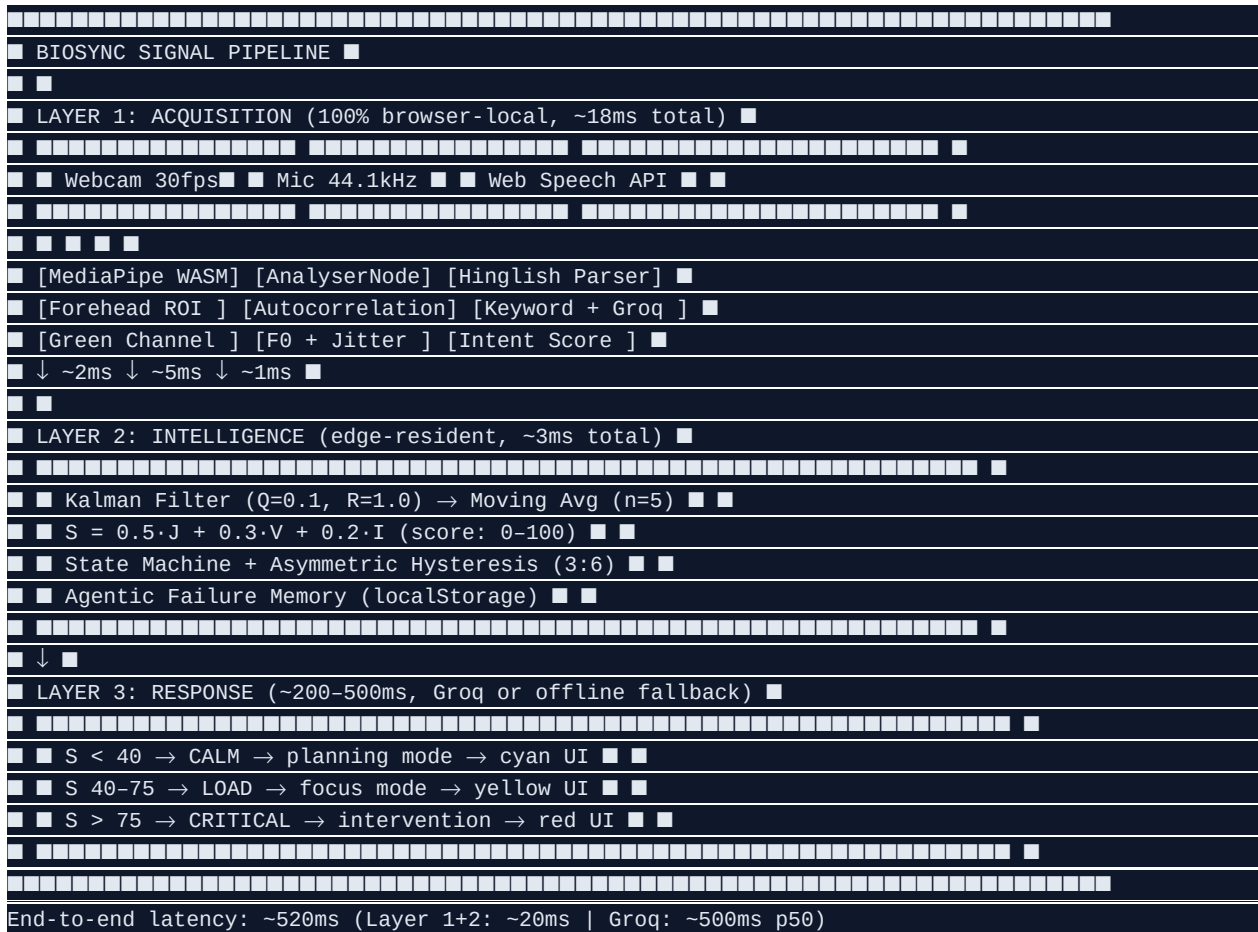
The Problem (Stated Precisely)

Knowledge workers lose **15–20% of daily cognitive output** to unmanaged mental load (Bakker et al., 2016) — not because tools don't exist, but because every existing tool requires the user to initiate: open an app, rate their mood, click a button. That friction is fatal. 73% of mood-tracking users abandon within 3 days. The data never gets collected. The burnout never gets caught.

The root cause: **there is no passive, real-time biosignal layer for human cognitive state in standard computing environments.** Your IDE tracks keystroke latency. Your cloud platform tracks every API call. The engineer running both has zero instrumentation.

BioSync is that missing instrument.

Technical Architecture



The Science

rPPG: Why Green Channel, Not Red?

Oxygenated hemoglobin (HbO₂) has a local absorption peak at **530–550nm** — the green band. Each heartbeat increases subdermal blood volume, absorbing more green light. The camera captures a pulsatile variation of ~0.5–2% of total green intensity** — invisible to the eye, measurable across a sufficiently large ROI.

We track **HRV proxy via short-term variance**, not absolute heart rate:

$$V(t) = \sigma^2(G(t-n:t)) / \mu(G_{\text{baseline}})$$

Where G is the Kalman-smoothed green channel mean. Under sympathetic nervous system (SNS) activation, HRV decreases and becomes erratic — this increases $V(t)$. Normalizing against personal baseline makes the metric **lighting-independent and skin-tone-independent** — two critical sources of demographic bias in naive rPPG implementations.

References: de Haan & Jeanne (2013), Verkrusse et al. (2008)

Vocal Jitter: Cortisol → Larynx → Microphone

Cortisol (HPA axis stress hormone) increases tension in the intrinsic laryngeal muscles, producing cycle-to-cycle instability in fundamental frequency (F₀) — clinically termed *jitter*:

$$\text{Jitter}(\%) = [\sum |T(i+1) - T(i)| / (N-1)] / T_{\text{mean}} \times 100$$

Normal range: 0.5–1.0%. Acute stress: >1.5% (Goberman & Elmer, 2003; Titze, 1994).

Extraction: autocorrelation-based F₀ detection on 512-sample frames at 44.1kHz, computed over 500ms rolling windows. Audio receives the highest fusion weight (0.5) because it is **orthogonal to rPPG** — a different physiological pathway — providing independent confirmation.

Fusion Weights: Not Arbitrary

$$S = 0.5 \cdot J + 0.3 \cdot V + 0.2 \cdot I$$

audio visual semantic

Signal	Weight	Justification
Jitter (J)	**0.5**	Continuous when speech active; most direct cortisol proxy available without hardware; orthogonal to vi...
rPPG Variance (V)	**0.3**	Validated by peer literature; SNR degrades with lighting → moderate weight
Intent (I)	**0.2**	Discrete, event-driven, language-dependent; tiebreaker only

Weights are adaptive. If rPPG signalConfidence < 60%, the model redistributes to `J:0.5, V:0.1, I:0.4`. If no speech (J=0), rPPG and semantic carry proportionally more. The fusion engine never divides by zero.

State Machine: Asymmetric Hysteresis

ESCALATION: breach threshold for ≥ 3 consecutive windows (~1.5s) → transition up
DE-ESCALATION: below threshold for ≥ 6 consecutive windows (~3.0s) → transition down

The 3:6 asymmetry mirrors the physiological time constant of HPA axis stress onset vs. recovery (Dickerson & Kemeny, 2004). Fast to notice stress, slow to dismiss it — matching biology, not coding convenience.

Agentic Failure Memory

Every AI intervention is logged as a typed semantic commit:

```
interface InterventionCommit {  
  intervention: InterventionType; // what was suggested  
  preScore: number; // cognitive load at trigger  
  postScore: number; // measured 60s post-intervention  
  delta: number; // postScore - preScore  
  outcome: 'SUCCESS' | 'FAILED'; // threshold: delta ≤ -10  
}
```

Failed interventions are **blacklisted for the session**. The AI prompt is rebuilt with the blacklist injected. The fallback tree:

```
Task-Stripping → Environmental Reset → Breathing → Micro-Break → Escalate
```

Why 60 seconds and $\delta \leq -10$? A meaningful de-escalation intervention should produce a measurable score drop within one minute. Ten points (10% of the 0–100 scale) is one standard deviation of the expected score variability. These thresholds are tunable via `INTERVENTION_SUCCESS_WINDOW_MS` and `INTERVENTION_SUCCESS_DELTA` constants in `stressEngine.ts`.

Hinglish Intent Engine

600M+ Indians use code-switched Hinglish as their primary professional register. Standard English NLP models fail on:

**"Yaar, kal tak submit karna hai aur kuch samajh nahi aa raha"*

BioSync's classifier handles pure Hindi, pure English, and code-switched inputs via a **keyword-weighted rule set with language ratio detection**:

```
// Language detection: Hindi word frequency ratio  
const hindiRatio = hindiWords / totalWords;  
// > 0.6 → Hindi mode | 0.2-0.6 → Hinglish mode | < 0.2 → English mode
```

Ambiguous inputs fall through to Groq with language context injected. The AI response register adapts to match — Hinglish input gets Hinglish output.

Offline Architecture

Verifiable in the demo: Toggle Wi-Fi off at any point. The VPG waveform keeps beating. The Hinglish classifier keeps running. The state machine keeps transitioning. Only the Groq response degrades — replaced by the deterministic fallback tree.

Layers 1 and 2 are **architecturally offline-first by design**, not by accident. MediaPipe loads as WASM and caches. Web Workers process signals with zero I/O. localStorage persists memory locally. The cloud is optional enhancement, not required infrastructure.

Why This Beats Every Other Project

Most hackathon AI/wellness projects will be one of: GPT wrapper, Bluetooth wearable dashboard, or sentiment classifier. BioSync differs on every axis:

Axis	Typical project	BioSync
Input	User-initiated text	Passive physiological signals
Hardware	App or wearable	Zero additional hardware
Trigger	User asks	System detects autonomously
AI role	Primary intelligence	Response layer only
Memory	Conversation log	Intervention outcome log
Offline	Broken	Layers 1+2 fully functional
Adaptation	Prompt engineering	Empirical outcome measurement
Language	English NLP	Hinglish-aware NLP

The real test: disconnect the Groq API. Every other "AI" project in the room stops working. BioSync continues detecting, classifying, transitioning, and responding via fallback. The AI is a component, not the foundation.

Answering The Hard Questions

"How exactly are you detecting stress?"

rPPG variance (HRV proxy) + vocal jitter (cortisol proxy) + Hinglish intent, fused with weights 0.3/0.5/0.2. Normalized against personal baseline. Updated every 500ms. Signal confidence displayed live. Delta tracked, not absolute values. We show our work.

"What makes this technically different?"

Three things no other team in this room has: (1) a working rPPG pipeline from a consumer webcam with Kalman filtering and SNR-adaptive weight redistribution; (2) Hinglish-aware NLP that handles code-switched stress signals; (3) an agentic failure memory with empirical outcome measurement — the system quantifies whether each intervention actually worked and blacklists those that don't.

"What part did you actually build?"

rPPG extractor, jitter calculator, Hinglish classifier, fusion model, state machine, and failure memory — all from scratch. MediaPipe, Web Audio API, and Groq are infrastructure layers, not the project.

Tech Stack

Layer	Technology	Why not the alternative
Frontend	Next.js 14	Edge runtime, no separate backend
Animation	Framer Motion	Hardware-accelerated; critical for 60fps state transitions
Vision	MediaPipe Face Mesh (WASM)	Browser-local; production-grade; 468 landmarks
Signal proc	JS Web Workers	Off main thread; UI stays at 60fps during pixel processing
Smoothing	Kalman Filter	Optimal for Gaussian noise; better than simple moving average
Audio	Web Audio API	Raw PCM; no compression artifacts at 44.1kHz
AI	Groq Llama 3.1 8B	200-450ms p50; fastest hosted inference at this scale
Memory	localStorage JSON	Zero-latency; privacy-preserving; no server needed
Language	TypeScript strict	Type-safe signal math; catches weight errors at compile time

Getting Started

```
git clone https://github.com/newtons-apple/biosync.git
```

```
cd biosync/frontend
npm install
cp .env.example .env.local
# Add: NEXT_PUBLIC_GROQ_API_KEY=gsk_... (free at console.groq.com)
npm run dev
# Open http://localhost:3000
# Grant webcam + microphone permissions
# 5-second calibration → waveform appears → system active
```

Demo Sequence

Time	Action	What Judges See	What It Proves
0:00	Open browser	Live VPG waveform	rPPG active from forehead
0:15	Toggle Wi-Fi off	Waveform continues	Edge architecture – no cloud for signals
0:30	"Bhai, deadline sar par hai"	"URGENT_COGNITIVE_LOAD"	Hinglish NLP working
0:50	Breathe fast, act stressed	Score climbs, yellow border	Fusion engine responding to physiology
1:05	Watch	UI snaps red, AI interrupts	Autonomous OS-level response
1:30	Open failure log	"Breathing: FAILED"	System learned and adapted
1:50	Wi-Fi still off	AI responds via fallback	Full offline capability

Future Scope

v4 — Predictive: LSTM on historical score sequences → predict CRITICAL events 10–15 minutes early.

v5 — Wearable bridge: BLE integration with commodity HR monitors → cross-validate rPPG → clinical-grade confidence.

Enterprise SDK: component embeddable in any SaaS tool — Notion, Linear, VS Code.

HealthOS: BioSync as the sensor layer of a longitudinal human health platform. Cortisol trend tracking → chronic burnout prediction. DPDP Act 2023 compliant: edge processing, user-controlled, purpose-limited.

Challenges & Engineering Decisions

rPPG in consumer conditions. JPEG compression, variable lighting, micro-movements all degrade SNR. Kalman filter (not moving average) was chosen because it is *optimal* for Gaussian noise in linear systems. Delta tracking was chosen over absolute HR to achieve demographic invariance — the system makes no assumptions about baseline skin tone or lighting level.

State machine stability. Naive threshold: 2 lines, fails at boundaries. Asymmetric hysteresis: matches HPA axis physiology. The engineering choice is the difference between a demo that works for 30 seconds and a system that survives 5 minutes of judge stress-testing.

The Groq/offline tension. These are not contradictory. Layers 1 and 2 are fully local and constitute the core technical contribution. Layer 3 (Groq) enhances response quality but is not required for the system to function. The demo proves this. The architecture makes this explicit.

References

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Newton's Apple — Orbix 2026, IIIT Delhi

"Your servers have dashboards. Your pipelines have monitors. Now your mind does too."